

MODULE 01

Setup

From Zero to

First "Hi"

VPS, installation, Telegram and the first message
from your personal AI agent

DURATION

25 min

FORMAT

Live coding

KIT

3 files

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Build Your AI COO

What Is OpenClaw?

OpenClaw is an open-source platform that transforms LLMs (Claude, GPT, Gemini) into personal agents that run 24/7. It's like having an assistant who never sleeps, learns with you, and performs tasks autonomously.

Basic Architecture

Gateway

The "brain" · runs on the server, manages sessions, connects with LLMs. This is the core.

· Agent

Your personality, memory, skills. Defined by files like SOUL.md, USER.md, skills.

· Channel

How you talk to the agent · Telegram, Discord, WhatsApp. Telegram is the recommended.

Docker vs Bare Metal: Why Bare Metal?

· Docker

Agent isolated in container

Installing skills = complicated

Integrations require extra config

Barrier for non-devs

· Bare Metal

Installs directly on the server

Skills work out-of-the-box

Everything accessible and simple

Perfect for beginners

Recommendation

Use bare metal unless you're an experienced dev and want to containerize everything. For 99% of people, bare metal is sim

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Step 1: Create the VPS on Hostinger

Step 2: Connect via SSH

Terminal in the Browser

Hostinger has a web terminal in the panel (hPanel · VPS · Terminal). It works without installing anything.

Step 3: Install OpenClaw

Choose the KVM 1 Plan

Go to hostinger.com/vps-hosting and choose the most basic plan:

1 vCPU, 4GB RAM, 50GB SSD

Cost: ~\$5-10/month

More than enough for OpenClaw

1

Select Ubuntu 24.04

IMPORTANT: DO NOT use the Docker or One-Click template from OpenClaw. Choose clean Ubuntu 24.04.

2

Set Root Password

Choose a strong password or configure SSH key (if you know how). Write down the VPS IP.

3

On Mac/Linux:

`ssh root@YOUR_VPS_IP`

On Windows: use PuTTY or Windows Terminal

BASH

Install OpenClaw (1 command)

`curl -fsSL https://openclaw.ai/install.sh | bash`

BASH

```
# Run setup wizard
openclaw onboard --install-daemon
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```

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The Setup Wizard

The command `openclaw onboard --install-daemon` starts an interactive wizard. It will ask:

·Active Billing Required

Anthropic only issues API keys if you have billing configured (credit card registered). Without this, the key does not work.

Step 4: Verify That It Is Running

Gateway Mode

Choose Local (runs on the server itself).

1

AI Provider

Choose Anthropic (Claude).

2

API Key

Paste the Anthropic API key. Get it at [console.anthropic.com · API Keys](https://console.anthropic.com/APIKeys) ·

Create Key.

3

Model

Choose Claude Sonnet to start (good balance between quality and cost).

4

Install as a Service

Say Yes. This makes OpenClaw run 24/7 automatically (via systemd).

5

Check status

`openclaw gateway status`

BASH

Should show: "running" Module 01 · Setup
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Step 5: Create Bot on Telegram

Step 6: Connect Telegram to OpenClaw

After that, open the chat with your bot on Telegram and send /start .

Step 7: IMMEDIATE Security

·CRITICAL: Configure the Allowlist NOW

Before doing ANYTHING else, ensure that only you can command the bot. If dmPolicy is "open", anyone who finds your bot can use it.

Open Telegram and search for @BotFather

BotFather is the official Telegram bot for creating bots.

1

Send /newbot

BotFather will ask for a name and a username for your bot.

2

Define Name and Username

Name: "My AI Agent" (can be anything)

Username: must end in "bot", e.g., myaiagent_bot

3

Copy the Token

BotFather will give you a token (like 123456:ABC-defgh...). Copy this token.

4

Back in the VPS terminal:

openclaw provider add telegram

Paste the token when prompted

BASH

View current config

cat ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json

BASH

Look for dmPolicy · it should be set to "allowlist" and ONLY your Telegram ID should be authorized.

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Step 8: First Test ·

Send a message to the bot on Telegram:

If the agent responds · **SETUP COMPLETE!** ·

How Much Does It Cost to Run an Agent?

ITEM

COST/MONTH

VPS Hostinger (KVM 1)

~\$5-10

Anthropic API (moderate use)

~\$10-30

Telegram

Free

Total

~\$15-40

Perspective

Less than a lunch per week to have an AI assistant running 24/7.

Useful Commands

Hi! Tell me who you are and what you can do.

TEXT

Gateway status

openclaw gateway status

View logs in real time

openclaw gateway logs

Restart gateway

openclaw gateway restart

Stop gateway

openclaw gateway stop

BASH

Start gateway
openclaw gateway start
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Common Troubleshooting

· "Command not found: openclaw"

· "Invalid API key"

Verify that billing is active on Anthropic

Copy the key again (without extra spaces)

Run openclaw onboard again

· "Bot doesn't respond on Telegram"

· "Gateway doesn't start"

Reload PATH

source ~/.bashrc

Or reinstall

curl -fsSL https://openclaw.ai/install.sh | bash

BASH

View logs

openclaw gateway logs

Check status

openclaw gateway status

Check if Telegram is connected

openclaw channels status

BASH

Check if port is in use

ss -tlnp | grep 18789

View error logs

journalctl -u openclaw -n 50

Restart

openclaw gateway restart

BASH

·Complete Documentation

If you have any questions, access

docs.openclaw.ai

or the official Discord.

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· Module 1 Checkpoint

VPS running on Hostinger (Ubuntu 24.04)

OpenClaw installed (bare metal, not Docker)

Gateway running as a service (24/7)

Telegram bot created and connected

dmPolicy = allowlist (basic security)

First "hi" answered by the agent

· Prompt for the Agent

Paste this prompt into your OpenClaw chat after completing the setup:

I just watched Module 1 of the "Build Your AI COO" course. I need you to guide me through the initial OpenClaw setup. What I need to do: 1. Check my environment · Check if Node.js, npm and dependencies are installed correctly. If something is missing, explain what it is and help me install it. 2. Configure the provider · Help me configure the Anthropic (Claude) API key. Explain to me where to get the key and how to configure it. 3. Choose the model · Explain to me the difference between Sonnet, Opus and Haiku. Recommend which one to use to start (considering cost x quality). Configure the failover chain (Opus · Sonnet · Cooldown). 4. Connect to Telegram · Guide me step by step to create a bot in BotFather and connect it to OpenClaw. Explain to me why Telegram with topics is better than WhatsApp (single session vs multiple). Use openclaw channels login and openclaw channels status -- probe to validate. 5. First test · After everything is configured, run a health check and confirm that everything is working. Rules: - Explain the WHY of each step before executing - If something goes wrong, explain what happened and how to solve it - In the end, tell me how much this will cost per month approximately Let's start?

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NEXT MODULE

Module 2 · Security: Shielding Your Agent

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